

Word family: **top / tops / topped / topping / topmost / topper**

Base word: top

Plural noun: tops

Verb forms: **top / tops / topped / topping**

Related forms:

* **top** (n.) — 頂部；上端；最高點

* **top** (adj.) — 最高的；最重要的；最優秀的

* **top** (v.) — 位居……之首；超過；蓋在……上面

* **topmost** (adj.) — 最上面的；最高的

* **topping** (n.) — 配料；頂層配料

* **topper** (n.) — 加在上面的東西；頂層裝飾物（視語境而定）

Useful extensions:

* **on top of**

* **on top of that**

* **at the top**

* **top of the page**

* **top of the class**

* **top priority**

* **top speed**

* **top quality**

* **top level**

* **top player**

* **top the list**

* **top the charts**

* **from top to bottom**

* **over the top**

* **off the top of your head**

* **on top of the world**

* **stay on top of something**

Meaning in this passage

> **On top of that**, he is kind.

Here, **on top of that** does **not** refer to physical position.

It is a discourse expression meaning:

in addition to what has already been mentioned — 除此之外；而且；再加上

The speaker has already described Leo's positive energy and enthusiasm, and then adds another positive quality: he is kind.

****中文翻譯：****

****除此之外 / 而且****，他還很善良。

So here:

****on top of that = 除此之外；再加上；而且****

1. ****top (最上面；頂部) — 頂部；上端****

This is the central literal noun meaning.

Practice 1

> There is a small flag at the ****top of the building****.

大樓****頂部****有一面小旗。

Practice 2

> Put your name at the ****top of the page****.

把你的名字寫在頁面的****頂端****。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****top = 某物最高、最上面的位置或部分****

2. ****the top of something —的頂端 / 上部****

Practice 1

> We finally reached the ****top of the hill****.

我們終於到達山丘的****頂部****。

Practice 2

> There was snow on the ****top of the mountain****.

山的**頂部**有積雪。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****the top of something = 某物最高或最上面的部分****

3. ****at the top — 在最高處；在最上面****

Practice 1

> Her office is ****at the top of the building****.

她的辦公室在大樓的****最上層****。

Practice 2

> The title appears ****at the top of the screen****.

標題顯示在螢幕的****頂部****。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****at the top = 位於某物最高或最上方的位置****

4. ****top (容器、盒子等的蓋 / 上面) — 頂部；上蓋****

Practice 1

> Put the ****top**** back on the bottle.

把瓶子的****蓋子****蓋回去。

Practice 2

> The box has a clear plastic ****top****.

這個盒子有一個透明塑膠****上蓋****。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****top = 容器最上面的部分或蓋子****

5. **top** (衣服：上衣) — 上衣

Especially in everyday clothing vocabulary.

Practice 1

> She was wearing a white **top** and black trousers.

她穿着一件白色**上衣**和黑色長褲。

Practice 2

> I bought two new **tops** yesterday.

我昨天買了兩件新**上衣**。

MCQ-ready definition:

top = 穿在上半身的衣服，尤其指女裝上衣

6. **top** (最高位置 / 最高排名) — 首位；榜首；最高位置

This moves from physical height to ranking.

Practice 1

> Their team is at the **top of the league**.

他們的球隊位居聯賽**榜首**。

Practice 2

> She finished at the **top of her class**.

她以全班**第一名 / 最優秀成績**完成課程。

MCQ-ready definition:

top = 排名、成績或地位中的最高位置

7. **at the top of your profession/field** — 處於行業頂尖位置

Practice 1

> She is at the **top** of her profession.

她處於自己專業領域的**頂尖位置**。

Practice 2

> It takes years to reach the **top** of the field.

要達到這個領域的**頂尖水平**需要多年時間。

MCQ-ready definition:

the top = 某個專業、領域或競爭中的最高地位或水平

8. **top** (adjective : 最高的) — 最高的 ; 最上面的

Practice 1

> The restaurant is on the **top** floor.

餐廳位於**最高一層**。

Practice 2

> Put the books on the **top** shelf.

把書放在**最上面的架子**上。

MCQ-ready definition:

top + noun = 位於最高或最上方的

9. **top** (最重要的) — 最重要的 ; 首要的

Practice 1

> Safety is our **top** priority.

安全是我們的**首要事項**。

Practice 2

> This issue is at the **top** of the agenda.

這個議題是議程中****最重要的項目之一 / 首要議題****。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****top = 在重要性上排名最高的；最優先的****

10. ****top (最優秀的) — 頂尖的；最出色的****

Practice 1

> She is one of the country's ****top athletes****.

她是全國其中一位****頂尖運動員****。

Practice 2

> He studied at a ****top university****.

他曾就讀一所****頂尖大學****。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****top = 在質素、能力、聲譽或表現方面屬於最高水平的****

11. ****top quality — 最高品質；優質的****

Practice 1

> The restaurant uses ****top-quality ingredients****.

這家餐廳使用****優質食材****。

Practice 2

> Customers expect ****top quality**** at this price.

以這個價錢來說，顧客會期望有****最高品質****。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****top quality = 品質非常高、屬於最佳水平****

12. ****top speed — 最高速度****

Practice 1

> The car can reach a **top speed** of 220 kilometres per hour.

這輛車的**最高速度**可達每小時 220 公里。

Practice 2

> The train was travelling at **top speed**.

火車正以**最高速度**行駛。

MCQ-ready definition:

top speed = 某人或某物所能達到的最高速度

13. **top level — 最高層級；最高水平**

Practice 1

> She has competed at the **top level** for years.

她多年來一直在**最高水平**的賽事中競爭。

Practice 2

> The decision was made at the **top level of management**.

這項決定由管理層的**最高層級**作出。

MCQ-ready definition:

top level = 某個體系、組織或能力範圍中的最高層次

14. **top (verb : 位居第一) — 位居榜首；排名第一**

Practice 1

> The song **topped the charts** for three weeks.

那首歌連續三星期**位居排行榜榜首**。

Practice 2

> She **topped the class** in mathematics.

她在數學科**考獲全班第一**。

MCQ-ready definition:

top = 在排名、成績或排行榜上位居第一

15. **top the list** — 位居名單之首

Practice 1

> Cost **tops the list** of customers' concerns.

成本**位居顧客最關心事項之首**。

Practice 2

> Improving safety **tops the list** of priorities.

改善安全問題在優先事項中**排在第一位**。

MCQ-ready definition:

top the list = 在一系列項目中排名第一或最重要

16. **top something (超過 ; 勝過)** — 超過 ; 勝過

Practice 1

> Last year's sales **topped** ten million dollars.

去年的銷售額**超過**一千萬美元。

Practice 2

> It will be difficult to **top** her performance.

要**超越**她的表現並不容易。

MCQ-ready definition:

top = 超過某個數量、紀錄或表現

17. ****top something with something — 在……上面加上……****

Practice 1

> The cake was ****topped with strawberries****.

蛋糕上面****鋪了草莓****。

Practice 2

> The soup is ****topped with fresh herbs****.

湯上面****加了新鮮香草作配料****。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****top something with X = 把 X 放在某物最上面，作為覆蓋或配料****

18. ****topping (食物配料) — 頂層配料；加在食物上的配料****

Practice 1

> What ****toppings**** would you like on your pizza?

你的薄餅想加甚麼****配料****？

Practice 2

> The ice cream comes with several different ****toppings****.

這款雪糕配有幾種不同的****配料****。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****topping = 放在食物上面以增加味道或裝飾的配料****

19. ****on top of something (在……上面) — 在……的上面****

Literal use.

Practice 1

> The keys are **on top of the table**.

鎖匙在桌子的**上面**。

Practice 2

> She put the books **on top of the box**.

她把書放在箱子的**上面**。

MCQ-ready definition:

on top of something = 位於某物的上方表面

20. **on top of something** (除此之外 ; 再加上) — 除.....之外還.....

Figurative extension from stacking one thing above another.

Practice 1

> **On top of** his regular job, he also teaches at night.

除了日常工作之外，他晚上還要教書。

Practice 2

> We had to pay a service charge **on top of** the basic price.

除了基本價錢之外，我們還要支付服務費。

MCQ-ready definition:

on top of something = 除了已經存在的事情之外，再增加另一件事

21. **on top of that** — 除此之外 ; 而且 ; 再加上

This is the expression used in your passage.

Practice 1 — original sentence

> **On top of that**, he is kind.

除此之外 / 而且，他還很善良。

Practice 2

> The hotel was expensive, and ****on top of that****, the service was terrible.

那間酒店很貴，****而且更糟的是****，服務也很差。

Practice 3

> She is intelligent and hardworking. ****On top of that****, she is extremely patient.

她聰明又勤奮，****除此之外****，她還非常有耐性。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****on top of that = 在剛才提到的事情之外，再補充另一項事情；除此之外；而且****

22. ****on top of something (掌握；控制好某事) — 掌握某事；處理得井然有序****

A very useful figurative meaning.

Practice 1

> I have a lot of work, but I'm ****on top of it****.

我有很多工作，但我仍然****掌握得到 / 處理得很好****。

Practice 2

> You need to stay ****on top of your finances****.

你需要一直****掌握自己的財務狀況****。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****be/stay on top of something = 對某件事保持充分掌握，並及時處理****

23. ****get on top of someone — 使某人感到壓力大得難以應付****

Especially BrE.

Practice 1

> The workload is beginning to ****get on top of me****.

工作量開始令我**感到難以應付 / 壓力沉重**。

Practice 2

> Don't let the stress **get on top of you**.

不要讓壓力**把你壓垮**。

MCQ-ready definition:

get on top of someone = 某種壓力、問題或負擔開始令某人難以應付

24. **on top of the world — 非常開心；得意洋洋**

A common idiom.

Practice 1

> She felt **on top of the world** after getting the job.

她得到那份工作後**開心得不得了**。

Practice 2

> After winning the competition, he was **on top of the world**.

贏得比賽後，他感到**無比興奮和快樂**。

MCQ-ready definition:

on top of the world = 感到極度開心、自信或成功

25. **from top to bottom — 從上到下；徹底地**

Practice 1

> We cleaned the house **from top to bottom**.

我們把整間屋**從上到下徹底清潔了一遍**。

Practice 2

> She examined the document **from top to bottom**.

她把文件**由頭到尾仔細檢查**了一遍。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****from top to bottom = 從最上面到最下面；引申為全面、徹底地****

26. ****over the top — 過火的；過度誇張的****

A common idiom.

Practice 1

> The decorations were a bit ****over the top****.

那些裝飾有點****過分誇張****。

Practice 2

> His reaction was completely ****over the top****.

他的反應實在****太過火了****。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****over the top = 過分、誇張，超出合理或必要程度的****

27. ****off the top of your head — 不經查證地憑記憶立即回答****

Practice 1

> ****Off the top of my head****, I can think of three examples.

****我現在憑記憶隨口想****，可以想到三個例子。

Practice 2

> I don't know the exact figure ****off the top of my head****.

我****現在一時憑記憶****說不出確切數字。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****off the top of your head = 沒有事先查資料或仔細思考，只憑當下記憶立即作答****

28. **topmost** — 最上面的；最高的

Practice 1

> The bird sat on the **topmost branch**.

那隻鳥停在**最高的一根樹枝**上。

Practice 2

> The documents are in the **topmost drawer**.

文件放在**最上面的抽屜**裏。

MCQ-ready definition:

topmost = 位於最頂部、比其他所有位置都高的

Important distinction 1: **top** vs **upper**

top

means the highest part or position.

> the **top shelf**

最上面的架子

upper

means situated relatively high, but not necessarily the absolute highest.

> the **upper floor**

較高的樓層 / 上層

So:

top = highest

upper = higher part

Important distinction 2: **top** vs **summit**

top

ordinary and very broad.

> the **top of the mountain**

山頂

summit

specifically the highest point of a mountain, and figuratively a high-level meeting.

> reach the **summit**

到達山頂

So **summit** is narrower and often more formal.

Important distinction 3: **top vs peak**

top

highest position generally.

peak

highest point, especially of performance, level, demand, or a mountain.

> at the **peak** of his career

> 事業巔峰

> at the **top** of his profession

> 行業頂尖位置

They overlap, but **peak** often suggests the **maximum point in a rise-and-fall pattern**.

Important distinction 4: **top vs best**

top

often means among the highest-ranked or highest-quality.

> a **top university**

一所頂尖大學

best

more directly means better than all the others.

> the **best university for this subject**

在這個學科方面最適合 / 最優秀的大學

So **top** does not always mean literally **number one**.

Important distinction 5: **top priority vs priority**

A **priority** is already something important.

A **top priority** means it is among the **most important / highest-priority** matters.

> Safety is a **top priority**.

安全是**首要事項**。

Important distinction 6: **on top of vs above**

Literal:

> The book is **on top of** the box.

書在箱子上面，而且通常暗示**接觸着箱子**。

> The lamp hangs **above** the table.

燈吊在桌子**上方**，不必接觸桌子。

So:

* **on top of** → often directly on/against the upper surface

* **above** → at a higher position

Important distinction 7: literal vs additive ****on top of****

Literal

> The phone is ****on top of the book****.

電話在書的****上面****。

Figurative

> ****On top of**** the cost, we had to pay tax.

****除了**費用外**，我們還要交稅。

The figurative idea is metaphorically:

****one thing stacked on another****

→ ****one additional issue added to another****

Important distinction 8: ****on top of that vs besides****

Both can mean ****此外 / 而且****.

****on top of that****

Often emphasizes that another point is being added to an already established situation.

> The work is difficult. ****On top of that****, the deadline is very tight.

工作很困難，****而且****限期也非常緊迫。

****besides****

Broader and can also mean 「況且 / 此外」.

> ****Besides****, we don't have enough time.

****況且 / 此外****，我們也沒有足夠時間。

****On top of that**** has a stronger sense of ****adding another layer****.

Important distinction 9: ****on top of that vs what's more****

Both add information.

****on top of that****

conversational and vivid; can add either positive or negative information.

****what's more****

slightly more rhetorical/formal.

> She is talented. ****What's more****, she works extremely hard.

她有天分，****而且****非常勤奮。

Important distinction 10: ****on top of that vs to make matters worse****

These are not interchangeable.

****on top of that****

neutral: the extra thing may be positive or negative.

> He is funny, and ****on top of that****, he is kind.

他很風趣，****而且****還很善良。

****to make matters worse****

only introduces an additional ****negative**** development.

> We missed the bus, and ****to make matters worse****, it started raining.

我們錯過了巴士，****更糟的是****，還開始下雨。

Your Leo sentence is positive, so ****on top of that**** is perfect.

Important distinction 11: ****be on top of something vs be at the top of something****

Very different.

be on top of something

= have it under control

> I'm **on top of my work**.

我的工作都**掌握得很好**。

be at the top of something

= occupy the highest rank/position

> She is **at the top of her profession**.

她在自己的專業中處於**頂尖地位**。

Important distinction 12: **top as noun vs adjective vs verb**

Noun

> the **top** of the hill

> 山頂

Adjective

> a **top** player

> 頂尖球員

Verb

> She **topped** the rankings.

> 她在排行榜上**位居第一**。

This is a genuine and useful POS shift within the same family.

Family-extension note

Top is a strong polysemy candidate because the concrete spatial idea of **「最高 / 最上面」** has developed into several highly productive abstract meanings:

1. **physical upper part**

* top of a mountain

* top of a page

2. **highest rank or level**

* top of the class

* top of the profession

3. **highest importance or quality**

* top priority

* top university

* top quality

4. **verb extensions**

* top the charts

* top a record

* top something with cheese

5. **figurative expressions**

* on top of that

* stay on top of something

* on top of the world

* over the top

* off the top of your head

The key is not to split every **top + noun** collocation into a new meaning. **Top player**, **top university**, and **top quality**, for example, all share the broader sense **「最高水平 / 最優秀」**.

Master comparison

Form / expression	Traditional Chinese	Core idea	
-----	-----	-----	
top of the building	建築物頂部	highest physical part	
top of the page	頁頂	uppermost position	
top of the mountain	山頂	highest point	
a top (container)	蓋；頂部	upper covering	
a top (clothing)	上衣	upper-body clothing	
top of the class	全班第一 / 頂尖	highest rank	
top of the profession	行業頂尖	highest status	

top floor	最高一層	uppermost	
top priority	首要事項	highest importance	
top athlete	頂尖運動員	highest quality/ability	
top quality	最高品質	excellent quality	
top speed	最高速度	maximum speed	
top level	最高層級 / 水平	highest level	
top the charts	位居榜首	rank first	
top the list	位居首位	rank first	
top a record/figure	超過紀錄 / 數字	exceed	
top with X	在上面加 X	place on upper surface	
topping	配料	food placed on top	
on top of X	在 X 上面	physical position	
on top of X	除 X 外還.....	additional layer	
on top of that	除此之外；而且	add another point	
be on top of X	掌握 X	have under control	
get on top of someone	令某人難以應付	overwhelm	
on top of the world	非常開心	extreme happiness	
from top to bottom	從上到下；徹底地	whole extent	
over the top	過火；誇張	excessive	
off the top of your head	憑記憶隨口回答	immediate recall	
topmost	最上面的	absolute highest	

For your original sentence

> **On top of that**, he is kind.

Here:

on top of that = 除此之外；而且；再加上

The image behind the expression is:

one physical thing placed on top of another

→ **one additional fact added to facts already mentioned**

The speaker has already said that Leo:

* lights up the room

* has contagious enthusiasm

Then adds another quality:

> **On top of that, he is kind.**

A natural Traditional Chinese translation is:

> **除此之外，他還很善良。 **

or:

> **而且，他還很善良。 **

So the passage uses the **additive figurative sense**, not the literal spatial meaning of **top**.